Structuring a Basic Python Conversational Loop

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Task

Build a simple rule-based conversational chatbot in Python. The chatbot must interact continuously with the user, recognize different messages, provide appropriate responses, and allow the user to exit.

Approach

The program asks for the user's name once, then runs inside a **while True** loop so the conversation continues until the user leaves. Each message is converted to lowercase and stripped of extra spaces, then checked with an **if / elif / else** chain: exit or bye (prints a goodbye and ends the loop with **break**), hello or hi (greeting), joke (tells a joke), how are you (replies and asks back), and any other message (asks the user to try again).

Input (Code)

```
name = input("What is your name: ").lower().strip()

while True:

    message = input("You: ").lower().strip()

    if "exit" in message or "bye" in message:

        print(f"Bye {name}")
        break

    elif "hello" in message or "hi" in message:

        print(f"Hey there {name}")

    elif "joke" in message:

        print("That's great. Take a spoon and fill it with water.")
        print("Then jump into that 😂")

    elif "how are you" in message:

        print(f"Thanks for asking....❤️ How are you Mr. {name}?")

    else:

        print("Sorry I can't hear you. Try with another message")
```

Figure 1: Python code of the rule-based chatbot

Output

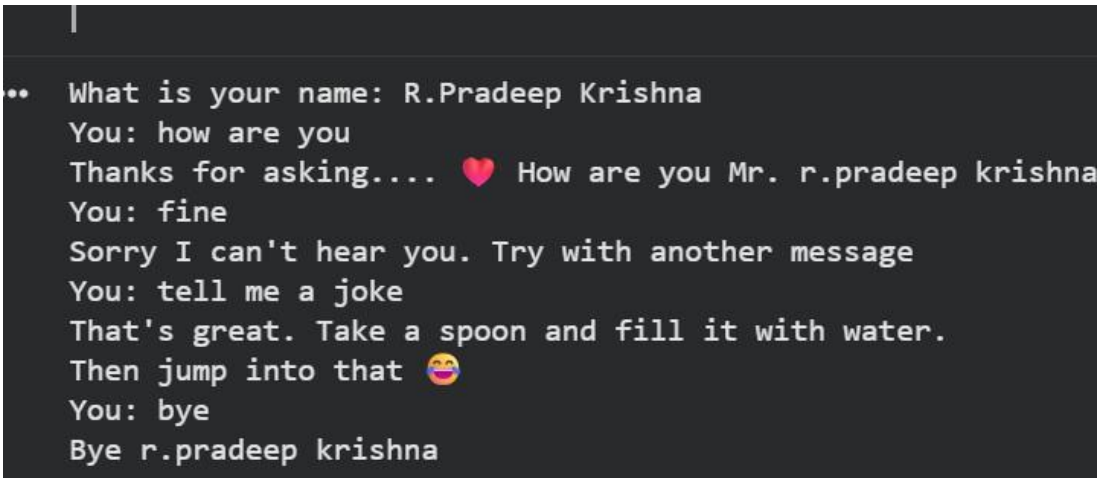


Figure 2: Sample conversation produced by the chatbot

Conclusion

The chatbot runs continuously, responds to different kinds of messages with suitable replies, handles unknown input with a fallback message, and ends cleanly when the user types exit or bye.